

UNIT – 3 – 2nd Half Part



1. Digital Marketing Planning and Setup
2. Digital Marketing Operations Setup

Department of Mechanical Engineering



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Digital Marketing Planning and Setup

Understanding digital media planning terminology and stages, steps to creating marketing communications strategy, introduction to search marketing, display marketing, social media marketing.

Digital Marketing Operations Setup

Basics of lead generation and conversion marketing, website content development and management, elements of user experience, web usability and evaluation.

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Basics of Lead Generation and Conversion Marketing

Lead generation, by definition, is the generation of consumer attention or inquiry into products and services of a business. A lead is differentiated from a visitor or a prospect primarily in its intent, as it is more 'qualified,' thus, has higher chances of conversion. In our discussion on the REAN Marketing Funnel, we touched upon the development of a lead in the 'Engage' stage beyond which it has to be activated through what we know as 'conversion marketing.'

Conversion, according to a specialized digital marketing research firm, Marketing Sherpa, refers to "The point at which a recipient of a marketing message performs a desired action." Conversion marketing, thus, is the set of marketing activities undertaken by a firm/brand to encourage the consumer undertake specific actions that the firm wants them to take. These actions could be across any of the stages of the marketing funnel. Getting a potential consumer fill up a registration form on a website is a conversion. Having the same customer download a whitepaper is another form of conversion. Finally, buying the product on the firm's site is the most desirable of all forms of conversions.

In this chapter, we would understand how firms can set up conversion marketing activities for the set of leads they have with them at any moment in time. But first, let us look at the process of lead generation following which we will cover the ways conversion marketing is deployed to convert qualified leads to real customers, who finally make a purchase.

Explanation of Marketing and Consumer Funnel Stages

'Marketing Funnel' as depicted in Fig. 1.4 consists of four **REAN** model stages (including the additional added stage of Plan) which can be described as:

- (a) **Plan:** Develop marketing plan, content strategy, and branding material which would be used to conduct marketing across the following funnel stages.
- (b) **Reach:** Involves the set of activities to raise prospect's attention to marketer's brand product or service. (This is the stage where prospects are created.)
- (c) **Engage:** The gradual, typically multi-channel set of activities needed to engage the prospects developed during the 'Reach' stage (This is the stage where leads are generated.)
- (d) **Activate:** The activities needed for prospects to take the actions marketers want them to take. (This is the stage which relates to final converts or those who purchase.)
- (e) **Nurture:** The activities needed to nurture the customer relationship created in the activation stage. (This is the stage which relates to creation of loyalists.)

Lead Generation Process:

The lead generation process helps businesses find and manage potential customers (leads) effectively. Here's how it works in simple terms:

1. Agreeing on What Counts as a Lead

The marketing and sales teams must agree on what qualifies as a lead.

Example: A person who visits a car dealership and asks for a test drive is a lead, but someone who just walks by may not be.

2. Collecting Leads from Different Sources

Businesses need a system to gather leads from various places, such as websites, social media, email campaigns, and events.

Example: A clothing brand collects leads from Instagram ads, website sign-ups, and in-store promotions.

3. Sorting Leads for Better Targeting

Leads should be categorized based on factors like location, budget, and urgency.

Example: A real estate company may classify leads as:

High priority: Ready to buy a house within a month.

Medium priority: Looking to buy within six months.

Low priority: Just exploring options.

4. Filtering Out High-Quality Leads

Companies should identify and focus on serious buyers rather than just random inquiries.

Example: An online course provider prioritizes leads who have already attended a free webinar over those who just visited the website.

5. Setting Rules Between Sales and Marketing Teams

Marketing finds leads, and sales teams follow up. A clear agreement ensures leads are not wasted.

Example: A software company's marketing team gathers leads through a free trial. The sales team must contact each lead within 24 hours to convert them into paying customers.

This process ensures that businesses don't waste time on uninterested people and focus on those more likely to buy.

Basics of Conversion Marketing

Conversion marketing is all about turning potential customers (visitors, leads) into actual buyers. Instead of just attracting traffic, the goal is to encourage people to take a specific action, like making a purchase, signing up for a newsletter, or requesting a demo.

Key Elements of Conversion Marketing

Clear Call-to-Action (CTA)

Tell customers exactly what to do next.

Example: A "Buy Now" button on an e-commerce website or a "Sign Up for Free" button for an online course.

Landing Pages that Convert

A well-designed page focused on a single offer helps in better conversions.

Example: A fitness brand's landing page offers a **"7-Day Free Workout Plan"** in exchange for an email address.

Personalization & Targeting

Show relevant offers based on customer behavior.

Example: Amazon suggests products based on what a user recently searched for.

Trust & Social Proof

People buy when they trust the brand. Reviews, testimonials, and guarantees help.

Example: A tech company displays **customer reviews** and "**Trusted by 500,000 users**" on its website.

Reducing Friction in Checkout/Sign-Up

A smooth, fast, and simple process leads to more conversions.

Example: An e-commerce store allows "One-Click Checkout" with saved payment details.

Retargeting & Follow-ups

Remind visitors who didn't convert the first time.

Example: An online clothing store shows **ads for abandoned cart items** on Facebook.

Example of Conversion Marketing in Action

A company selling online courses notices that many people visit their site but don't enroll.

They improve conversions by:

- ✓ Adding a "**Limited-Time Discount**" banner.
- ✓ Offering a "**Free First Lesson**" to gain trust.
- ✓ Sending **follow-up emails** to remind visitors about the course.

By implementing these strategies, businesses can **increase sales and customer engagement** efficiently.

Lead Management across Channels—Owned, Earned, and Paid

- Owned channels—website, blogs
- Earned channels—social media
- Paid media—SEM, e-mail marketing

(a) Website-based lead management

(b) Blog-based lead management

(c) Social media

(d) SEM (Search Engine Marketing)

(e) E-mail marketing

(f) Other paid channels

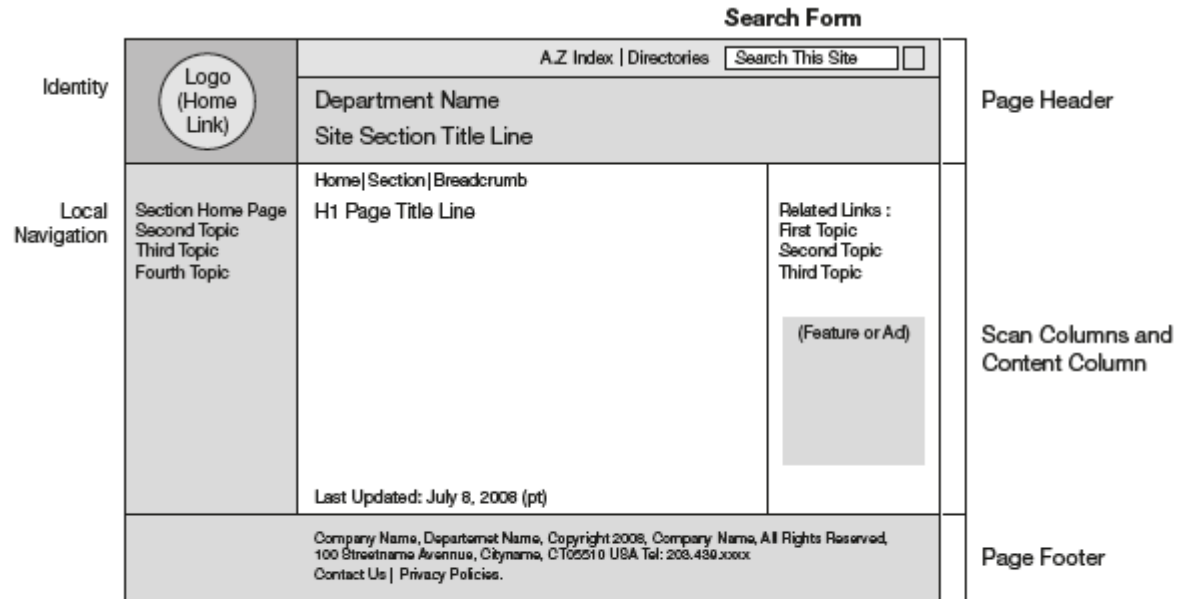
Reference: Page 254 to 256 – Book Puneet Singh Bhatia

With an understanding of how varied channels can be deployed across owned, earned, and paid media towards lead generation and conversion objectives, we will move further to the next part of this chapter to look at how companies can develop the most critical instrument of lead management, that is, the whole set of activities towards website development.

Also, we need to add here that in this section, we have covered the operational part of lead generation and conversions. To execute them, marketers need to develop elaborate marketing campaigns which we would discuss at length in Chapter 8.

Website Content Development and Management

Along with the creation of site diagrams and wireframe development, firms have to manage collation and development of relevant content to populate various site pages. The content for any website will largely be driven by the objectives of the site and interests of the audience who would be visiting the pages. Once the content is in place, it will go hand-in-hand in selecting the sections where specific content would be placed, depending upon its impact and relevance.



Courtesy: Patrick J Lynch and Sara Horton, Web Style Guide 3rd Edition, <http://webstyleguide.com/wsg3/3-information-architecture/4-presenting-information.html>, as accessed on 27 February 2017, at 8.55 pm.

Figure 7.2 Typical Page Wireframe Diagram

The key steps for defining and managing website content include:

- (a) **Understanding content expectations:** The first step for developing web content includes understanding user goals and expectations from the site. Firms should pre-research the type of information which would get users most engaged and make them stay for the longest time on the site.
- (b) **Defining key content areas:** As the next step, firms need to define and prioritize on key content areas to be given prime coverage and importance on the site.
- (c) **Analyzing content sources:** Firms then need to dig into their archives and content across prior brochures, sales collaterals, etc., to see the content they already have and to then decide whether they need to develop their own content internally or have the website vendor develop content with inputs shared by the firm.
- (d) **Revising outdated content:** An important part of content development is to identify and revise redundant content on the site and to update it with the latest product/service information.
- (e) **Developing content themes:** involves bucketing different types of content across themes to be covered across the site. These themes or arrangement of similar topics, will help in site definition and navigation elements so that users see a natural flow in the website as they progress across the web pages.
- (f) **Mapping content themes to sitemap:** involves developing content categories and placing content for different themes across site pages. A site page is a hierarchical diagram which

shows multiple parent pages (top pages of the website) and child pages under each of them.

- (g) **Outlining navigation:** The next stage, after mapping content to sitemap, involves placing each of the parent pages across their natural progression in the form of a navigation structure for users to follow.
- (h) **Labeling content:** It involves providing accurate and meaningful labels to content areas. The labels should be easy to understand with simple words to avoid any confusion.
- (i) **Placing content on pages:** This last stage involves placing requisite content pieces on specific web pages based on the wireframes developed earlier.

Web Content Management

Web Content Management (WCM) is about **creating, organizing, and managing content** on a website easily. Businesses use special software called a **Web Content Management System (WCMS)** to handle this process without needing advanced coding skills.

A **WCMS** helps companies:

- ✓ **Create content** (like articles, blogs, product pages)
- ✓ **Edit and update** content easily
- ✓ **Collaborate** with different team members
- ✓ **Publish content** on websites and other platforms

Example of WCMS in Action

Imagine an **e-commerce website** that sells clothes.

The company uses a **WCMS** to:

- Add **new product pages** with descriptions and images.
- Edit and update **pricing and stock availability**.
- Publish **blogs on fashion trends** to attract more customers.
- Allow multiple team members (writers, designers, and managers) to collaborate.

Popular WCMS Platforms

1.WordPress – Used for blogs, business websites, and even e-commerce.

2.Shopify – Best for managing online stores.

3.Drupal – Used by large organizations for complex websites.

4.Wix – A user-friendly platform for small businesses.

A **WCMS** makes website management **fast, easy, and efficient** without needing technical expertise!

Definition of User Experience (UX) and Usability

✓ User Experience (UX):

User Experience (UX) is the **overall feeling and satisfaction** a user gets while interacting with a website, app, or product. It focuses on **design, emotions, accessibility, and engagement** to ensure a pleasant interaction.

✓ Usability:

Usability is a **part of UX** that focuses on how **easy, efficient, and intuitive** a system is for users. A website or app with high usability allows users to **quickly find information and complete tasks without confusion**.

Difference between User Experience and Usability

Typically, user experience is confused with usability while both of them are different. Let us look at some key differences below.

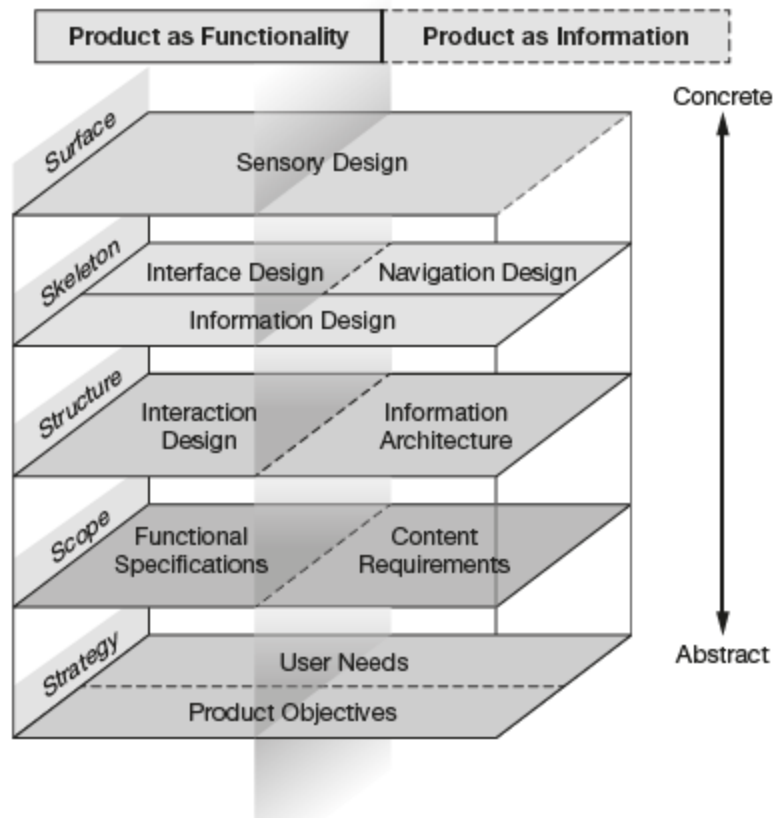
- (a)** Usability is about task-based interactions. It is the ability to easily execute process and transitions on the web with certain ease, while user experience is related to the experiential elements felt by a user when they interact with the website.
- (b)** Usability makes a task easy and intuitive, while user experience makes it meaningful and valuable.
- (c)** Usability involves reducing steps and roadblocks, while user experience aims at creating an emotional connection. At the most basic level, thus, usability relates to what users do and how they accomplish it, while user experience deals with what users feel about their involvement.

Difference Between UX and Usability

Aspect	User Experience (UX)	Usability
Definition	Overall experience and satisfaction of the user while interacting with a product.	How easy and efficient it is for users to achieve their goals on a website/app.
Focus	Looks at the entire journey of the user, including emotions and engagement.	Focuses only on ease of use and efficiency of completing tasks.
Components	Design, aesthetics, branding, accessibility, interaction, and usability.	Simplicity, learnability, speed, and ease of navigation.
Goal	To make the interaction enjoyable, meaningful, and user-friendly.	To ensure users can use the system without confusion or frustration.
Example	A mobile banking app that looks appealing, builds trust, and offers a smooth experience.	A banking website where users can easily transfer money without any unnecessary steps.

Usability is a **part of UX**, but UX is a **broader concept** that includes usability along with design, emotions, and engagement. A **good UX** ensures the product is both **usable and enjoyable**!

Elements of User Experience



The Five Planes of UX by Jesse James Garrett

1 Strategy Plane (Why?)

Focuses on the **goals** of both the business and users.

Defines the **purpose** of the website or application.

Example: An e-commerce site aims to sell products, while users want a smooth shopping experience.

2 Scope Plane (What?)

Defines the **features and functionality** the website will have.

Decides what **content** will be included.

Example: Should the site have a search bar? Will there be a product review section?

3 Structure Plane (How is it organized?)

Determines how information is structured and how users navigate.

Ensures logical **user flow** and **interaction design**.

Example: In an online store, the cart and checkout process should be easy to follow.

4 **Skeleton Plane** (Layout & Interface)

- Focuses on **wireframes, menus, buttons, and navigation**.
- Ensures a **smooth interaction experience**.
- Example: Where should the “Buy Now” button be placed for easy access?

5 **Surface Plane** (Look & Feel)

- Defines the **visual design** – colors, fonts, images, and aesthetics.
- Creates an **emotional connection** with users.
- Example: A banking app uses blue colors to create a feeling of trust and security.

These five planes help designers **build websites step by step**, ensuring they are both **functional and enjoyable to use!**

Understanding Web Usability

The definition of usability as a part of ISO 9241-11 standards is

“The extent to which a product can be used by specific users to achieve specified goals with effectiveness, efficiency, and satisfaction in a specified context of use.”

Whitney Quesenbery has shared a set of 5Es to usability as follows:

- (a) Effective:** It denotes the completeness and accuracy with which users achieve their goals.
- (b) Efficient:** It is the speed with which users complete their tasks.
- (c) Engaging:** It includes how pleasant, satisfying, or interesting an interface is to use.
- (d) Error tolerant:** It involves how well the product prevents and recovers users from errors.
- (e) Easy to learn:** It supports initial orientation and continued learning of the product.

It has to be noted here that although all five Es are important for usability, not all of them might be equally important in a particular scenario or for a specific project. The balance among the 5Es, thus, would depend on the prominence of feature and the type of stakeholder which is using that product. For example, for an e-commerce site selling products, efficiency and effectiveness could be most important, while for a site which is high on interactive educational learning, engaging and easy-to-learn attributes might be more important.

Thus, usability has to be analyzed and developed with a strong understanding of the specific situation and type of users at hand. Once firms have developed the requisite usability elements and incorporated them into the website, it is important that designers evaluate whether their final web product meets the required level of usability. We would need to develop an understanding of the concepts of usability evaluation to test if the application actually meets stated user requirements.

Usability Evaluation

It involves techniques to assess application functionality, verify the impact of the interface on users, and identify intermittent problems which might emerge. Evaluation can be performed either as formative evaluation (which takes place during design) or summative evaluation (which takes place after the product has been developed). There are typically two broad categories of evaluation methods that can be used at different stages of product development—user testing and usability inspection methods. It is to be noted that all evaluations should be conducted with the final user of the application and not with other stakeholders like developers or website owners. Let us study the two evaluation techniques—

1. User Testing (Testing with Real Users)

This method involves directly observing real users as they perform specific tasks on a website or app. The goal is to measure their performance, identify problems, and improve usability.

✅ Steps in User Testing:

- 1 Set Testing Goals → Decide what you want to test (e.g., checkout process, login page).
- 2 Choose Test Users → Select a diverse group based on age, experience, and frequency of use.
- 3 Pick Tasks → Users should perform real-world tasks (e.g., buy a product, sign up for a service).
- 4 Measure Performance → Track time taken, errors made, and user satisfaction.
- 5 Analyze and Improve → Use the results to fix usability issues and enhance the experience.

📌 Example:

An e-commerce company observes users trying to buy a product. If users struggle to find the "Add to Cart" button, the website layout needs improvement.

2. Inspection Methods (Expert-Based Evaluation)

Instead of testing with real users, experts predict usability problems based on their knowledge.

◆ Heuristic Evaluation (Expert Checklist Review)

- Experts check the website using a set of usability principles (called heuristics).
- Example: Checking if the site has clear navigation, error messages, and an undo option.

◆ Cognitive Walkthrough (Simulating User Behavior)

- Experts imagine themselves as new users and think through every action step-by-step.
- Example: If a first-time user wants to reset a password, is the process easy to find and follow?

◆ Web Usage Analysis (Tracking User Behavior)

- Website logs and analytics are studied to understand how users browse, click, and interact.
- Example: If data shows that many users leave the site on the checkout page, there may be an issue with the payment process.

Technique	User Testing (Real Users)	Inspection Methods (Expert Review)
Who Tests?	Real users	Usability experts
How?	Observing and measuring user behavior	Experts predict issues using checklists & simulations
Example	Watching users struggle with checkout	Expert finds missing "Continue" button on checkout page
Best For	Identifying real-world user problems	Finding early-stage design flaws